

Static electricity

When two objects rub together, charged particles can move from one to the other. One object becomes positively charged, the other negatively charged. The build up of charge is called static electricity. Positive and negative charges attract, so the objects stick together!

Electrical attraction

If you rub a balloon on your head, negatively charged electrons from your hair move to the balloon. The balloon becomes negatively charged and pushes away the other electrons in your hair, making the surface of your hair positively charged.

At first, the balloon and the hair have an equal mix of positively and negatively charged particles.

Rubbing the balloon against your hair moves electrons from your hair to the balloon.

! WOW!

**Lightning
can be more than
five times hotter
than the surface
of the Sun.**